Active Supervision Policy and Procedure

Performance Standard

§1302.90 Personnel policies.

(a) *Establishing personnel policies and procedures*. A program must establish written personnel policies and procedures that are approved by the governing body and policy council or policy committee and that are available to all staff.

(c) Standards of conduct.

(1) A program must ensure all staff, consultants, contractors, and volunteers abide by the program's standards of conduct that:

(i) Ensure staff, consultants, contractors, and volunteers implement positive strategies to support children's well-being and prevent and address challenging behavior;

(ii) Ensure staff, consultants, contractors, and volunteers do not engage in behaviors that maltreat or endanger the health or safety of children, including, at a minimum:

(A) Corporal punishment; or physically abusive behavior, defined as intentional use of physical force that results in, or has the potential to result in, physical injury. Examples include, but are not limited to, hitting, kicking, shaking, biting, pushing, restraining, force feeding, or dragging;

(B) Sexually abusive behavior, defined as any completed or attempted sexual act, sexual contact, or exploitation. Examples include, but are not limited to, behaviors such as inappropriate touching, inappropriate filming, or exposing a child to other sexual activities;

(C) Emotionally harmful or abusive behavior, defined as behaviors that harm a child's self worth or emotional well-being; and

(D) Neglectful behavior, defined as the failure to meet a child's basic physical and emotional needs including access to food, education, medical care, **appropriate supervision by an adequate caregiver**, and safe physical and emotional environments. Examples include, but are not limited to, leaving a child unattended on a bus, withholding food as punishment or refusing to change soiled diapers as punishment;

(vi) Ensure no child is left alone or unsupervised.

Active Supervision: https://headstart.gov/safety-practices/article/active-supervision

Active supervision promotes a safe environment and prevents injuries in young children. It requires focused attention and intentional observation at all times. Staff use active supervision strategies to make sure children of all ages explore their environments safely. Each program can keep children safe by teaching all staff how to look, listen, and engage.

Keeping children safe is a top priority for all Head Start programs (45 CFR §1302.102). The Head Start Program Performance Standards require that programs "ensure no child is left alone or unsupervised by staff, consultants, contractors, or volunteers while under their care" (45 CFR §1302.90).

Using active supervision, staff position themselves so that they can always observe all children — watching, counting, and listening. During transitions, they account for all children with name-to-face recognition by visually identifying each child. Staff also use their knowledge of each child's development and abilities to anticipate what they will do, then get involved and redirect them when necessary. This constant vigilance helps children learn safely. Review "Caring for Our Children" standard 2.2.0.1: Methods of Supervision of Children.

All Head Start staff and volunteers are responsible for making sure no child is left unsupervised. Active supervision is a strategy that works. It can be used in classrooms, family child care, playgrounds, and buses. It can also be shared with families as a tool to use at home. Read below for how to implement active supervision, and print and display the at-a-glance handout and poster to remind everyone of active supervision strategies.

Policy

All staff, and adults in our program are responsible for actively supervising children at all times. Staff will use active supervision strategies to position themselves, scan and count children, anticipate behaviors, listen carefully, and engage and redirect as needed to promote a safe and supportive environment.

Procedure

Staff Roles & Responsibilities:

All Staff

- Maintain constant supervision of all children in their care, including field trips and on transportation.
- Use active supervision strategies, including positioning, scanning, counting, and engaging with children.
- Ensure no child is left alone or unsupervised at any time, including field trips and on transportation.

Classroom Teacher

- Establish and implement the active supervision plan for the classroom and outdoor areas.
- Assign supervision zones to staff to ensure full visibility of children during different routines of the day (ex. outside and center time). Have zoning plans easily accessible and articulated with the team.
- Have Active Supervision Daily Schedule Tracker with the number of children in attendance updated at all times. Must be completed at all threshold transitions and should be clearly visible as people enter the classroom.
- Monitor transitions to ensure all children are accounted for. Clearly establish responsibility for who will count and write the attendance number on the attendance board for all transition times. Make all staff and volunteers in the classroom aware of active supervision procedures.
- Post Active Supervision Poster and Scan and Count Poster near doorway in classroom
- Substitute folder should include explicit plans for active supervision across the day. Updated 1520 report with children's names and emergency contacts in substitute folder and emergency backpack.

Educational Assistants

- Follow the active supervision plan and maintain clear communication with the lead teacher.
- Assist in scanning, counting, and engaging children in a way that ensures safety.
- Maintain Active Supervision Daily Schedule Tracker with the number of children in attendance updated at all times. Must be completed at all threshold transitions.
- Immediately report concerns or potential hazards to lead teacher
- If teacher is not in the classroom (ie. on break or substitute teacher) take over teacher role in scanning and counting or advise others in the room to do so.

Program Leadership

- Provide Active Supervision Poster and safety signs for all classrooms, hallways and transition points.
- Provide training to all staff on active supervision and ensure compliance with grant safety standards.
- Anytime a coach, administrator, mental health consultant, or family advocate (or other program staff that is not assigned to a classroom) enters the classroom, they need to scan and count children and check with the number written on the daily schedule tracker. Verbally state the number of children counted. If there is a discrepancy, work with the teacher to make sure all children are accounted for and the correct number documented on the tracker.
- Conduct regular observations – formal and unannounced – to assess supervision effectiveness and provide corrective feedback as needed. See monitoring procedures below.

Active Supervision Expectations

1. Set Up the Environment

- Arrange furniture and play areas to maximize visibility.
- Keep pathways clear for easy movement and supervision.
- Ensure outdoor play areas are free of hazards and that staff have clear sightlines to all children.

2. Position Staff Strategically

- Staff should position themselves to see and hear all children at all times.
- During free play, staff should be stationed near high-risk areas (e.g., climbers, doorways).
- Staff should remain mobile, shifting their positions as needed to maintain supervision.
- **Classrooms Roles and Responsibilities Form includes Zoning Plans**. Documentation especially for nap time, centers, and playground. Maps will be posted on the playground.

3. Scan and Count

- Staff must continuously scan the environment to monitor children's activities.
- Conduct frequent headcounts throughout the day.
- Write the number of children on Active Supervision Daily Schedule Tracker. Must be **completed at all threshold transitions** and should be **clearly visible** as people enter the classroom.
- Change the total number as children arrive or leave early.
- Extra vigilance is required when moving between spaces (ie. classroom to playground, bathroom, etc.)

Ongoing Communication

- If children are taken outside of the classroom/gym/playground (ex. To the bathroom), staff will clearly state, "I am taking X number of students. You have X number of students with you."
- If children arrive late or leave early, staff **verbally communicate** to all other staff of change of attendance number. Staff verbally acknowledges change in number. Attendance board updated when returns to classroom.

Scan and Count Procedure for Transitions

Before Transitioning to a New Location:

- Classroom staff **count** all children.
- The total number of children is **stated out loud** so all staff can hear.
- Staff visually checks that the **count matches and documents** the number on the tracker.
- Once the numbers align, the transition begins.

Upon Arrival at the New Location:

- Classroom staff **immediately count** all children again.
- The updated count is **stated out loud** for all staff to confirm.

4. Listen Actively

- Pay attention to sounds, as unusual silence or distress may indicate a concern.
- Use auditory cues, such as bells, alarm or chimes on doors, to monitor safety

5. Anticipate Children's Behavior

- Use knowledge of children's development to predict behaviors and potential risks.
- Observe individual children for signs of distress, distraction, or unsafe play.
- Intervene early to prevent conflicts or unsafe situations.

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6. Engage and Redirect

- Stay actively involved with children's play and learning.
- Provide guidance and redirection to encourage safe and positive interactions.
- Support children in problem-solving and making safe choices.

Emergency Procedures

- If a child is missing, staff must:
  - Immediately alert the lead teacher
  - Conduct an immediate search of the area while ensuring other children are supervised.
  - If a child is not found within one (1) minute, alert Early Learners Admin on the 2-way radio (or phone if radio is not available) to call for support in the classroom to continue search.
  - Deploy School Emergency Response team until the child is located.

Training & Accountability

- All staff (including staff that are hired throughout the year) will receive training on active supervision during Onboarding and annually thereafter.
- Training will be incorporated into professional development throughout the school year.
- Program leadership will conduct routine monitoring and provide feedback to staff.
- Any lapses in active supervision will be documented in the Active Supervision ChildPlus module and addressed with additional training and/or corrective actions.

Monitoring Procedures

To ensure consistent implementation of active supervision strategies, program leadership will monitor each of the six domains through structured observations and documentation.

1. Set Up the Environment, Position Staff, and Scan & Count

- Program leadership will **complete the** **Active Supervision Checklist** during transition times in each classroom to document active supervision procedures.
- Monitoring will occur **monthly** within the first two weeks of the month.
- Completed checklists will be **entered in ChildPlus** under "Management" → "Internal Monitoring" → Active Supervision. Early Learners Administrators and/or delegate will collect checklists and enter data.
- Monthly reports will be run by the Data Manager to verify compliance and identify any areas needing reinforcement. Data will be reviewed at the School Emergency Team (SET) at the monthly meeting.

2. Anticipate Behavior, Listen Actively, and Engage & Redirect

- These supervision strategies will be monitored through **classroom observations** conducted **quarterly** using the **Danielson Observation Tool**.
- Observations will focus on staff responsiveness to children's behaviors, active listening, and effective redirection technique.
- Documentation of these observations will be recorded in Classroom Mosaic to track implementation and provide targeted coaching or support as needed.